Priesthood Temples and Women

The Belief Files

Case File 006

Historical investigation and biblical assessment

Beyond the Message | LDS origins and authority | November 2026

Investigation summary

In Nauvoo, Joseph Smith organized women into the Relief Society, supported their participation in healing blessings, and introduced temple ordinances that would include women as well as men. The surviving records contain language about ordination, authority, keys, and priesthood. This case asks what those records establish, how practices developed, and how the resulting claims compare with the New Testament. [1–11]

The documents support a substantial role for early LDS women in leadership and religious practice. They do not, simply by using the word ordain, establish that women received Aaronic or Melchizedek priesthood office in the sense used by the Church today. The same evidence also prevents a claim that women's historical authority amounted to no meaningful authority at all. [3–9, 15]

The larger question is the source and purpose of the system. Current LDS teaching connects restored priesthood authority, temple covenants, and exaltation. Establishing that Smith taught and organized these things is different from establishing that his authority came from heavenly messengers or that these ordinances restore the practice of the ancient apostles. The Christian assessment examines that further claim rather than questioning the sincerity or value of women's service. [12–20]

The claim under investigation

Several related propositions require separate examination:

- Priesthood authority lost after the ancient apostles was restored through Smith by heavenly messengers. This is the Church's religious account, not a conclusion established by the existence of the later organization. [2, 15]
- Women can exercise delegated priesthood authority without being ordained to Aaronic or Melchizedek priesthood office. [15]
- Smith's teachings and the Relief Society records provide historical roots for women's participation in priesthood-related ministry and temple ordinances. [3–11]
- Temple covenants and sealing are connected with the highest promised celestial glory. The terms salvation, eternal life, and exaltation must be defined before comparing them with Christian usage. [12–14, 17]
- The system restores divine truth and provides authorized means of drawing near to God. That claim requires theological assessment as well as historical description.

The project writes from an evangelical and Trinitarian Christian perspective. Christians disagree about ordination, sacramental ministry, apostolic succession, and women's eligibility for particular church offices. This case does not treat one Protestant account as a complete description of every Christian tradition. Its focus is the particular LDS restoration and temple claim.

How this investigation weighs evidence

Ask what a word meant in its setting. Ordain may refer to appointment or setting apart rather than conferral of a particular priesthood office. Keys can describe different kinds of authorization or knowledge. A definition used in a current handbook cannot simply be inserted into every nineteenth-century sentence. [4–9]

Preserve the source's date and transmission. The March 1842 minutes survive as a copied record, probably entered soon after the meeting, rather than Smith's own transcript. A reminiscence written forty years later is another kind of evidence. Neither should be silently presented as a recording of the speaker's exact words. [4, 8]

Distinguish practice from supernatural authorization. Minutes can establish that leaders organized a society or endorsed healing prayer. They do not independently establish that an angel conferred the authority claimed for the organization.

Compare practice across time. The evidence for women's early healing blessings and the current restriction on formal administration to the sick should both remain visible. A historical change can be documented without assuming that its cause was either divine correction or deliberate deception. [6–7, 16]

Keep the central theological question clear. Women's meaningful ministry and disagreement about a claimed restoration can coexist. The issue is whether the particular authority and temple requirements are warranted, not whether LDS women contribute to their community.

The historical timeline

Date	Record or development	Investigative significance
July 1830	A revelation to Emma Smith authorizes instruction and other responsibilities. [3]	Women's religious work predates the Nauvoo Relief Society.
March 17 1842	The Relief Society is organized, and Emma Smith is elected president. [4–5]	A surviving record documents governance and appointment language.
April 28 1842	Smith addresses spiritual gifts and women laying hands on the sick. [6–7]	The early healing practice is supported by a specific recorded teaching.
May 4 1842	The Nauvoo endowment is introduced to a small group of men. [10]	The specific ordinance has a documented place in Smith's later ministry.
May and July 1843	Teachings now in sections 131 and 132 connect marriage with exaltation. [13–14]	The authority question reaches beyond administration into eternal destiny.
September 1843	Women are included in Nauvoo temple ordinances; an event entry identifies Joseph and Emma on September 28. [2, 11]	Temple participation must be distinguished from ecclesiastical office.
1880 and 1882	Taylor's meeting report and Kimball's reminiscence preserve later usage and recollection. [8–9]	Later sources illuminate reception while requiring their own dating.
Present handbook checked in 2026	Women exercise delegated authority; formal administration to the sick is assigned to Melchizedek Priesthood holders. [15–16]	The present system includes both participation and specified limits.

Exhibit one The Relief Society records

The March 17 minutes record an actual organization with a president, counselors, decisions, and responsibilities. They describe service to the poor and the moral and religious work of the community. Emma Smith's election and the appointment of counselors show women exercising identifiable governance within the society. That finding does not depend on deciding the supernatural source of the institution. [4–5]

The record also uses language of appointment associated with the surrounding church structure. Smith proposed a presidency and spoke of ordaining its officers to preside. Readers should ask what office was being established and what authority its holders actually exercised, rather than treating one occurrence of ordain as a complete description of priesthood conferral. [5]

Doctrine and Covenants 25 provides an earlier point of comparison. Its instruction to Emma includes expounding scripture and exhorting the Church. The revelation does not establish that every current office existed in its later form in 1830; it does establish a textual basis for women's religious responsibilities within early LDS teaching. [3]

The transmission of the March minutes matters. The Joseph Smith Papers explains that Willard Richards initially took minutes, Eliza R. Snow became secretary, and the surviving account appears to have been copied into the minute book soon afterward. The original notes apparently do not survive. This makes the record valuable early evidence without making it a verbatim autograph of Smith's words. [4]

Exhibit two Healing and changing practice

The April 28 record is direct evidence that Smith supported women laying hands on the sick in faith. In the recorded discourse, he connects signs and healing with belief by women as well as men and rebukes criticism of the practice. This cannot responsibly be described as an activity wholly opposed by Smith. [6–7]

The same document discusses offices, order, and the roles people had been appointed to fill. Its recognition of healing therefore does not automatically establish that every woman who prayed with laying on of hands held a male ecclesiastical office. The distinction between a spiritual gift and a formally conferred office is part of the historical question, not an excuse to erase the practice.

The Church's historical essay describes women continuing to give healing blessings in the nineteenth century and the practice declining in the twentieth. It cites a March 26, 1926 letter from Heber J. Grant discouraging requests for sisters to administer and directing attention to the elders. This case reports that letter through the essay's citation; it does not claim independent inspection of the archival original. [2]

The current General Handbook gives a clear present rule: formal administration to the sick is performed by worthy Melchizedek Priesthood holders. This is a current official instruction, separately checked, rather than an assumption based on an older handbook cited by the essay. A description of that formal ordinance should not be inflated into a claim that women are forbidden to pray for sick people. [16]

The documented comparison is therefore between an endorsed early practice involving women and a later, more restricted formal administration. Why the change should be considered an authorized development is an LDS interpretive argument. That argument deserves examination, but the change itself should remain explicit.

Exhibit three The temple connection

The Nauvoo developments were connected with a larger account of divine presence and eternal destiny. Doctrine and Covenants 84 links priesthood ordinances with the manifestation of godliness and knowledge of God. Sections 131 and 132 connect the highest promised glory with an enduring marriage covenant and authorized sealing. These teachings make temple authority a theological issue as well as an organizational one. [12–14]

The Joseph Smith Papers glossary distinguishes earlier uses of endowment for spiritual gifts and power from the specific ordinance introduced on May 4, 1842. That distinction prevents a claim that every earlier reference to an endowment describes the complete later Nauvoo ceremony. Women's inclusion followed in 1843. [10–11]

An event entry for September 28, 1843 describes Joseph and Emma Smith being anointed and ordained to the highest and holiest order of priesthood. In this setting, the terminology concerns temple participation. It should not be silently equated with appointment as a bishop, apostle, or holder of another ecclesiastical office. Equally, its strong language should not be weakened into a claim that nothing religiously significant was being conferred. [11]

Today's public temple guidance connects ordinances and covenants with Christ, divine power, and eternal family relationships. The specific theological claims require their own support; charitable work or the existence of a religious ceremony cannot establish them. The public description is sufficient for this comparison, which does not depend on reproducing ceremonial details. [15, 17]

The historical record supports development within Smith's ministry. It does not, without an additional argument, establish an unbroken correspondence between the Nauvoo ordinances and practices of the first-century apostles. Calling the development a restoration names the religious explanation being tested.

Assessing the principal accounts

Source or witness	What it can establish	Limit on the inference
March 1842 copied minutes	Relief Society organization, women's offices, and recorded teaching. [4–5]	A copied meeting record is not Smith's own verbatim transcript.
April 1842 discourse record	Recorded endorsement of women's healing practice. [6–7]	It does not independently verify every claimed healing or imply a current priesthood office.
Kimball's 1882 reminiscence	A participant's later memory of the organization's beginning. [8]	Forty years elapsed; memorable wording requires comparison with earlier records.
Taylor's 1880 meeting report	Later appointment language and continued women's leadership. [9]	Later usage does not alone resolve every meaning intended in 1842.
Current handbook	Present official categories and instructions. [15–17]	Current definitions cannot by themselves establish all earlier practice or ancient authorization.

Kimball's reminiscence is often used for Smith's promise to organize women in the order of priesthood after the pattern of the Church. Her account is relevant testimony from someone involved, but its 1882 date should travel with the quotation or paraphrase. It is not a contemporaneous 1842 sentence merely because it describes that year's events. [8]

The July 17, 1880 report of Taylor setting apart women uses ordain alongside setting apart. Recalling his participation in 1842, Taylor said the earlier ordination did not confer priesthood upon the sisters. In the same passage, however, he described women as holding a portion of priesthood in connection with their husbands. Both statements belong in the comparison; the second should not disappear when the first is cited. [9]

Taylor's report illuminates a later understanding of the earlier event. It is not the original 1842 minute, and its family-related language should not automatically be equated with the categories of a current handbook. The record supports contextual reading without making every distinction between office and women's authority meaningless.

The sources also share institutional relationships. The modern essay, handbook, edited minutes, and glossary are not four independent witnesses to an angelic event. Their value differs: some transmit early records, some explain present teaching, and some provide scholarly editorial context. Labeling those roles makes the argument easier to evaluate.

The strongest LDS argument

The strongest defense begins with a distinction between authority to serve and ordination to an office. Women could lead, teach, exercise spiritual gifts, and participate in temple ordinances without receiving an Aaronic or Melchizedek office. The early records and current handbook both recognize meaningful participation, although their terms and practices require historical explanation. [3–11, 15]

Continuing revelation, on this view, permits leaders to clarify terminology and regulate ordinances. A change in healing administration would not necessarily contradict the conviction that God answers women's prayers. The temple system would be understood as Christ's authorized means of blessing people, not a competing savior placed alongside him. [2, 15–17]

That response is stronger than denying that practices changed or treating Christ as absent from LDS temple teaching. The further question is whether the restoration claim is warranted and whether the specified ordinances and covenant requirements follow from the apostolic witness. Evidence for women's participation does not, by itself, answer that question in either direction.

Competing explanations

Authorized restoration with continuing clarification

Smith received divine authority and introduced institutions and ordinances through revelation. Later leaders acted within that authority when defining roles or changing practice. This model can accommodate development. Its distinguishing premise is divine authorization, which the institutional records alone cannot independently verify.

Development within a nineteenth century religious movement

The organization, terminology, and rituals developed within the needs and theological interests of the early LDS community. The dated records are also compatible with this explanation. Establishing particular influences or conscious borrowing would require additional evidence; development alone does not prove insincerity.

Meaningful participation within a male governing structure

Women exercised real organizational, spiritual, and ritual responsibilities while authority to govern priesthood offices remained with men. This description can illuminate both the opportunities and the limits without claiming that women either possessed every form of authority or possessed none. It describes a structure; it does not establish that structure's divine origin.

Deliberate use of authority claims for control

A critic may argue that appeals to revelation were used knowingly to maintain institutional power. Authority did regulate who could administer ordinances and define their requirements. Establishing that someone knowingly made a false revelation claim is a further claim about intent. It is not demonstrated simply by identifying the authority structure or its benefits.

These explanations can overlap at the descriptive level. A historian can establish the sequence and participants more securely than a private motive

or supernatural cause. The theological comparison must state the additional reasoning by which it accepts or rejects the resulting religious requirements.

Motives benefits and costs

The Relief Society offered opportunities for charitable work, leadership, mutual support, and religious instruction. Temple teaching gave family relationships an eternal significance. These are understandable reasons people might value the institutions. Recognizing that value does not establish that the claims are true; neither does it justify treating every participant as manipulated. [4–5, 13–14]

The system also gives institutional authorization great practical weight. If particular ordinances are necessary for a promised eternal destiny, the power to authorize them matters deeply. That connection makes questions about priesthood keys and temple requirements appropriate subjects of investigation. [12–17]

This case does not claim that every woman experienced the system in the same way. Records of leaders' teachings do not replace the varied experiences of participants. A conversation should let a person describe both what she values and what she finds difficult without assigning her a ready-made story.

A biblical assessment

Christ's enduring priesthood

Hebrews 7:23-28 contrasts mortal priests with Christ, who continues and intercedes permanently. The project's Christian assessment understands his saving priesthood as sufficient because of who he is and what he has accomplished. This is the foundation of the question about a claimed later restoration of necessary priesthood authority. [18]

The argument must be stated precisely. Hebrews does not deny that churches have leaders, and LDS believers also affirm Christ's supremacy. They understand their priesthood as authority exercised under him. The

disagreement is whether the particular restored system is authorized, not whether an ordinary leader is intended to replace Jesus personally.

It is also unnecessary to make the entire case depend on translating one Greek word as nontransferable. The larger argument in Hebrews concerns Christ's enduring life, intercession, and completed sacrifice. Readers should compare that argument with the additional requirements asserted for exaltation rather than assume a disputed lexical gloss settles the issue.

Access to God and temple fulfillment

Hebrews 10:10-22 connects access to God with Christ's offering and invites believers to draw near through him. John 2:19-21 identifies Jesus' body with the temple in the saying discussed there. From the project's evangelical perspective, these passages locate decisive access in Christ rather than in Nauvoo-derived ordinances. [19–20]

That conclusion should not become the overstatement that Christians have no ceremonies or that all church order is unnecessary. Baptism, the Lord's Supper, communal worship, and recognized leadership remain important across Christian traditions, with substantial disagreements about their operation. The specific question is what warrants endowment and sealing as necessary parts of the promised highest eternal destiny.

LDS temple ordinances should not be described simply as a resumption of the Old Testament animal sacrifices addressed in Hebrews. Their public explanation concerns covenants and instruction centered on Christ. The Christian objection must engage those actual claims while explaining why the project's reading of the New Testament does not establish their necessity. [17, 19]

A priestly people and women's ministry

First Peter 2:5-9 addresses believers as a priestly people. Acts 2:17-18 includes women and men in the promised work of the Spirit. Romans 16 names women among Paul's fellow workers and commendations; Acts 18:26 describes Priscilla and Aquila instructing Apollos. Women are active participants in the New Testament's ministry. [20–21]

These passages do not automatically settle every question about elders, bishops, or ordination. Christians interpret them alongside passages such as 1 Timothy 2-3 and 1 Corinthians 11-14 and reach different conclusions. A criticism of LDS authority should not pretend that all other Christian traditions ordain women or that inclusion in spiritual gifts resolves every office question.

The narrower Christian claim is that meaningful service and access to God are grounded in Christ and the Spirit's work. Demonstrating a specific nineteenth-century channel of restored priesthood authority requires a further argument. The work of LDS women can be acknowledged fully while that claim remains disputed.

Healing gifts and the elders

James 5:14-16 instructs the sick to call the elders for prayer and anointing. First Corinthians 12 describes gifts distributed through the body of believers. Both passages belong in a fair comparison. James should not disappear merely because an argument emphasizes gifts; the wider teaching on gifts should not disappear merely because a church regulates an ordinance. [20]

The historical evidence establishes that women's LDS healing practice changed. Whether either the earlier practice or the present regulation is the best interpretation of these passages is a theological judgment. A reported healing also requires its own evidence before it is used as proof of a particular institution's divine authorization.

Marriage exaltation and grace

Sections 131 and 132 join marriage and sealing with the highest promised celestial glory. Christian readers should define that claim rather than translating every LDS use of saved into the same meaning. LDS teaching also holds that faithful people who lacked an opportunity in mortality will not be denied the promised blessings simply because of that circumstance. Presenting unmarried people as automatically excluded would misrepresent that explanation. [2, 13–14]

Matthew 22:23-33 discusses marriage in the resurrection. LDS interpreters distinguish new marriages there from sealings made beforehand; critics question whether the passage supplies that distinction. The response must be evaluated, not omitted. First Corinthians 7 honors unmarried service, while Ephesians 2:8-10 grounds salvation in grace and describes good works as the purpose of new life. [20]

From this project's evangelical reading, eternal life and final acceptance with God rest on Christ's saving work and are not conditioned on an eternal marriage rite. This states the Christian disagreement without denying the LDS emphasis on Christ, covenant faithfulness, or the value of family relationships.

Findings and confidence

Confidence concerns the historical or textual finding stated, not a numerical probability assigned to divine authority.

Finding	Confidence	Basis and limit
Early LDS women held meaningful religious responsibilities.	High	Revelation, minutes, and later leadership records. [3–9]
Smith endorsed women laying hands on the sick in faith.	High for the recorded teaching	The April 1842 record; individual healing claims require separate evidence. [6–7]
Ordain in these records always means current priesthood office.	Not established	Context and later appointment usage require distinction. [4–5, 9]
Present formal administration to the sick is restricted to specified male holders.	High	Current handbook independently checked. [15–16]

Finding	Confidence	Basis and limit
The records independently establish angelic authorization and ancient continuity.	Not established	They document a movement and its claims, not an independent observation of every claimed divine event.
Documented development proves conscious deception.	Not established	Sequence and institutional benefit do not independently establish intent.

Overall assessment

The records establish both participation and development. Women led an organized society, taught, exercised spiritual gifts, and entered temple ordinances. The evidence cannot responsibly be flattened into a claim that women either had every current form of priesthood office or had no religious authority at all. [3–11]

The formal administration of healing became more restricted, and later definitions distinguish office, delegated authority, keys, and power. Current teaching makes those distinctions explicit. Their present clarity does not erase the need to examine earlier language and practice on their own terms. [15–16]

The Christian assessment concerns what warrants the system's claims about necessary authority and access to God. From the project's perspective, the New Testament grounds that access in Christ's enduring priesthood and completed work. The dated LDS records establish what was taught and organized; an additional argument is needed to establish their claimed divine origin and necessity for exaltation.

Read compare and discuss

Read the March and April 1842 records, Doctrine and Covenants 25:7 and 131:1-4, and current General Handbook sections 3.4 and 18.13. Compare Hebrews 7:23-28 and 10:10-22, 1 Peter 2:5-9, James 5:14-16, and Romans 16. Keep a separate list of offices, gifts, delegated duties, and claims about eternal destiny.

1. What responsibility was actually given in the passage using ordain?
2. How does a copied meeting record differ from a reminiscence written forty years later?
3. What changed in healing practice, and what explanation is offered for the change?
4. What evidence would establish ancient continuity beyond the existence of the Nauvoo institution?
5. How does the strongest LDS reading understand the relationship between its priesthood and Christ?
6. What does Hebrews establish about Christ, and what further argument is needed about later offices or ceremonies?
7. Which Christian traditions differ from your own about women's ordination, and how should that affect your description?

A useful opening with an LDS friend is: "When you use priesthood, do you mean an office, authority to serve, or power received through covenants?" Ask which aspect matters most in that person's own experience. A follow-up is: "How do you connect that understanding with the access to God described in Hebrews?"

For group or family study, first identify women named in Romans 16 and the work described. Then identify the responsibilities in the Relief Society minutes. Compare the claims carefully before explaining the gospel. A person's service should be heard as part of her story, not treated as a problem to dismiss.

Accuracy notes and further research

- The supplied research packet is a working synthesis. Its broad claims have been checked or narrowed against identified records and current official instructions. [1]
- The March minutes and Kimball's 1882 memory are different witnesses with different dates. A later recollection should not be converted into a contemporary quotation. [4, 8]
- Neither ordain nor order of priesthood can automatically be translated into a current ecclesiastical office. Conversely, delegated authority should not be described as no authority. [5, 9, 11, 15]
- The 1926 letter is reported through the essay's archival citation, not represented as separately inspected. A full history of female healing requires a wider primary-source review. [2]
- Present practice was checked in the current General Handbook. The essay's reference to an older Handbook 2 is not used as the sole source for a current rule. [15–17]
- Temple history and current descriptions are distinguished. This case does not claim a complete reconstruction of the early ceremony or of every subsequent change.
- Hebrews is discussed from the project's Christian perspective. Catholic, Orthodox, and Protestant understandings of ministerial priesthood, succession, and sacramental authority differ.
- The historical evidence does not independently prove every supernatural claim, establish every participant's experience, or demonstrate deliberate fraud.
- A future book should include fuller review of the healing record, the development of authority vocabulary, and the archival sources behind the modern essay. Mother in Heaven and the plural-marriage cases provide related investigations without replacing this one.

Sources and reading

The register separates supplied research, early records, later recollections, modern explanations, current rules, and biblical comparison. Web sources checked November 8, 2026. KJV biblical text is distinguished from LDS chapter headings and interpretive footnotes.

[1] Supplied research. *LDS Gospel Topics Essays*, compiled 366-page project PDF, physical pages 129-163, Priesthood Temples and Women source packet. A working synthesis and question inventory, not independent corroboration of each historical or supernatural claim.

[2] Current LDS historical explanation. Joseph Smith's Teachings about Priesthood Temples and Women, Gospel Topics Essays. Includes the Church's interpretation of early language, nineteenth-century healing practice, and the 1926 Grant letter citation. The archival letter is not claimed as independently inspected here.

[3] Early revelation in current canon. Doctrine and Covenants 25, especially verses 3 and 7-8. Source for Emma Smith's religious responsibilities. Compare the text rather than treating every heading or later application as an original sentence of the revelation.

[4] Organization and recording history. Joseph Smith Papers, Minutes and Discourses 17 March 1842, historical introduction and source note. Identifies the copied minute-book account and the apparently nonextant original notes. It is not a verbatim autograph by Smith.

[5] Early governance and appointment. The same March 17 minutes, especially page 7 and page 8. Source for the society's purposes, presidency, counselors, and appointment language. Historical terms require interpretation in their local context.

[6] Early healing practice. Joseph Smith Papers, Minutes and Discourse 28 April 1842 page 36. Records Smith's response to criticism of women laying hands on the sick and his appeal to faith and spiritual gifts. It does not independently verify each reported healing.

[7] Discourse context. Joseph Smith Papers, Discourse 28 April 1842, historical introduction and transcription. Context for the discussion of callings, offices, and healing. This is related transmission of the same occasion, not an additional independent healing witness.

[8] Later participant memory. Sarah M. Kimball, Reminiscence 17 March 1882, in *The First Fifty Years of Relief Society*. The retrospective account is explicitly dated forty years after the organization's founding.

[9] Later leadership report. General Relief Society Meeting Report 17 July 1880, in *The First Fifty Years of Relief Society*. Uses setting apart and ordaining in appointing women leaders. The editorial introduction distinguishes the manuscript report from a similar later printed version.

[10] Historical terminology and chronology. Joseph Smith Papers, Endowment glossary topic. Distinguishes earlier promises of spiritual empowerment from the specific Nauvoo ordinance introduced May 4, 1842. This is modern editorial context with cited historical records.

[11] Temple participation in 1843. Joseph Smith Papers, Joseph and Emma Smith anointed and ordained to highest order of priesthood, event entry for September 28, 1843. Used for the identified event and its wording, not a complete reconstruction of the ceremony or a conferral of a current ecclesiastical office.

[12] Priesthood and ordinances. Doctrine and Covenants 84, especially verses 19-22 and 33-44. Source for the LDS connection among priesthood, divine power, covenant, and knowledge of God. The existence of the text does not independently establish its revelatory origin.

[13] Marriage and highest glory. Doctrine and Covenants 131, verses 1-4. Instructions attributed to May 1843. Distinguish the canonical wording and bracketed explanation from a claim to have inspected the original recording of every instruction.

[14] Sealing and exaltation. Doctrine and Covenants 132, especially verses 7 and 19-24. The marriage and plural-marriage setting requires fuller treatment in later cases. This case uses the stated relationship of authorized sealing and promised glory.

[15] Current authority categories. General Handbook chapter 3 Priesthood Principles, especially sections 3.1 and 3.4. Source for the current restoration claim and the distinctions among keys, office, and delegated authority. It describes official teaching rather than independently proving the supernatural claim.

[16] Current healing ordinance. General Handbook chapter 18, section 18.13.1. Present rule concerning who performs formal administration to the sick. This is not a prohibition on women's ordinary prayers for healing.

[17] Current public temple guidance. General Handbook chapter 27 Temple Ordinances for the Living. Source for the present official relationship of temple ordinances, covenants, and eternal family relationships; not evidence that every current feature existed unchanged in Nauvoo.

[18] Biblical priesthood comparison. Hebrews 7, especially verses 23-28, KJV. The project distinguishes the biblical argument concerning Christ from a publisher's headings or later interpretive apparatus.

[19] Biblical access to God. Hebrews 10, especially verses 10-22, KJV. The Christian assessment is stated as a theological reading of Christ's offering and the invitation to draw near.

[20] Biblical comparison passages. KJV, John 2:19-21; 1 Peter 2:5-9; Acts 2:17-18 and 18:26; James 5:14-16; 1 Corinthians 7 and 12; Matthew 22:23-33; Ephesians 2:8-10; 1 Timothy 2-3. These address priestly identity, ministry, gifts, healing, marriage, grace, and offices. Christian interpretive differences are acknowledged rather than erased.

[21] Women in the apostolic community. KJV, Romans 16, especially verses 1-7 and 12. Named women and their service supply a concrete comparison. Disputes over particular titles and ordination are not settled simply by listing the names.

Collection notes

Case File 006 follows The Book of Mormon and DNA and precedes Mother in Heaven. The LDS collection begins with 00 and continues through Cases 001-012, followed by the separate Christian conversation guide. Related marriage and exaltation subjects receive further treatment in their own cases.